Garages

Written by

Eduardo Garibay

Draft
4

This screenplay contains grief involving the verbal mention of a fatal car accident and the death of a romantic partner.

EXT. RESTAURANT — NIGHT

The neon diner sign hums. The street is mostly empty. A light breeze rustles through the trees. The soft chatter from inside fades as the door swings shut behind them.

RIVER
(grinning)
That waiter was definitely flirting with you.

She gives him a look—half amused, half dismissive.

JUNE
What? No way.

RIVER
(teasing, tilting his head)
Oh, please. Don’t even try to deny those extra fries. “The kitchen made too much”? Come on. That was some Romeo and Juliet level flirting. Honestly, I might go give him my number.

JUNE
(mock defensive, shrugging)
Maybe he just knows how to treat a lady.

INT./EXT. RIVER’S CAR

They reach the car. He opens the passenger door for her. She hesitates for a second, then gets in. He circles around, slides into the driver’s seat.

RIVER
(starting the car)
You might have a little fan club after tonight.

JUNE
(half-smiling, brushing it off, looking out the window)
I was just... trying not to get on his bad side.

RIVER
(glancing at her)
Or maybe you've just got one of those faces.

JUNE
(side-eyeing him)
What faces?

RIVER
(mock serious, watching the road as he pulls out)
The kind people give free stuff to, just to see that smile again.

She pauses, rolling her eyes, but there's something unreadable in the way she looks at him.

JUNE
Okay. Then what do I have to give to you?

He taps his fingers on the wheel, as if considering it.

RIVER
(softly, but matter-of-fact)
This. Tonight. This was good.

She settles into her seat, watching the city lights flicker by.

JUNE
(soft, but with meaning)
Yeah, It was.

Silence settles between them, not awkward, just present. The hum of the engine fills the space.

JUNE (cont'd)
(joking)
My ex used to steal my fries. Worst thing you can do to a lady, by the way. Should be a misdemeanor, Maybe a felony.

RIVER
(grinning, focused on driving)
Noted.

JUNE
(mock suspicion, raising an eyebrow)
Oh? You planning on treating a lady right?

RIVER
(nonchalant, turning onto a quieter street)
Maybe.

JUNE
So you are the good guy type?

RIVER
I try. Most of the time. Why? Want me to try again?

JUNE
(laughs)
Usually when guys say that, they have a horror story about an ex who "ruined" them. Also, how bold of you to assume there will be another date.

RIVER
(shrugging, smirk barely visible in the passing streetlights)
Why not? Third time's the charm.

The teasing lingers for a second.

JUNE
(leaning back, playful)
Alright, since we're being honest... what's the worst thing an ex has ever done to you? Set the bar for me.

RIVER
(He chuckles, shaking his head)
Oh, I don't know... ignored my texts, stole my hoodies, offered my soul to a dark entity in exchange for concert tickets—y'know, the typical.

JUNE
That's it? That's the worst?

RIVER
(he sighs)
No. I guess...

He looks out the windshield at the road.

RIVER (cont'd)
It's not really... a "horror story." Those usually have a villain.

JUNE
(her smile faltering)
You're getting serious on me River.

RIVER
The worst thing was just... not being there anymore.

JUNE
(The smile fades slightly)
Ghosted?

RIVER
(he tries to hold back a smile)
No. She, uh... she died. A car accident. Senior year.

Suddenly, the hum of the tires on the asphalt sound very loud.

JUNE
(Her voice is tiny)
Oh. God. I—I'm so sorry. I didn't—

RIVER
(He nods quickly, trying to shut it down)
No, it's fine. I mean, you didn't know. I shouldn't have... I didn't mean to just drop that on you.

He focuses intensely on the road, checking his mirrors even though the streets are empty.

JUNE
(soft, watching the lights pass outside)
Why don't you talk about her?

A pause. He breathes in like he might answer, but then lets it out, hands tightening briefly on the wheel.

RIVER
(quiet, honest)
I could. For hours. But it’s not exactly a conversation for over burgers and milkshakes on a date with someone I like.

She nods, trying to understand.

JUNE
(gentle, looking at him now)
I’d listen.

He glances at her, surprised.

RIVER
I’m a sucker for metaphors.

JUNE
(small smile, intrigued)
Yeah?

RIVER
I have this... weird theory. About garages. Or, like, how hearts are basically just storage units for people we used to know .

JUNE
(soft laugh, raising an eyebrow)
Garages?

RIVER
Yeah... It’s like... okay, imagine a garage.

June closes her eyes.

JUNE
(smiling)
A garage. Real romantic.

RIVER
No, shut up, stay with me. You put things in there. People you love. You give them the keys, they move their stuff in. And, most of the time, if—when they leave, they take their things with them. You’re left with an empty floor, but it's your floor again.

JUNE
(quietly)
But she didn’t.

RIVER
(correcting her)
She couldn’t. She didn't take anything. The garage is still full. Every corner . And I don’t have the heart to throw any of it away.

A slow nod from her. The weight of it is in the silence.

JUNE
(gentle, hesitant)
So... do you think there’s room in there for someone else?

His fingers flex on the wheel.

RIVER
(quiet, honest)
I think she’d want me to make room.

They sit in the stillness of that truth. Finally, they pull up to her apartment. The car idles. Neither of them move.

RIVER (cont’d)
I don’t think I’ve ever shared that much with anyone.

She doesn’t look at him, just nods.

JUNE
I’m glad you did.

A long beat. She reaches for the door handle, looking back at him with a small, almost teasing smirk.

JUNE (cont’d)
Third time’s the charm, huh?

He meets her gaze, his lips curving up slightly.

RIVER
(hopeful)
Maybe.

She lingers, then steps out.

He watches her go.

After a long beat, he reaches out and flicks the turn signal. The CLICK-CLACK starts.

He doesn't move. He just watches the green arrow blink on the dashboard. He stares at it like he's mesmerized by the rhythm.

CLICK-CLACK.

CLICK-CLACK.

He lets it go for five, six, seven times.

Finally, he exhales, shifts into gear, and pulls away from the curb.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

The car pulls away from the curb, the blinker still flashing rhythmically.

We stay on the long, empty street. The red taillights get smaller and smaller. The car turns the corner, but the faint CLICK-CLACK of the signal carries back through the quiet air for a second after the car is gone.

The street is empty.

FADE TO BLACK.